

Marketplaces

Extend, Create, Share — Plugin ecosystems for Copilot CLI

20 Minutes

Experienced Developers

What We'll Cover



What Are Plugins?

Agents, skills, hooks, and MCP servers packaged for reuse



Browse & Install

Find and install plugins from CLI marketplaces



Create a Plugin

Build your own plugin with plugin.json



Build a Marketplace

Create a registry and share with your team

What Is a Plugin?

A plugin is a package that extends Copilot CLI with one or more components:



Agents

Specialized AI assistants defined in
`.agent.md` files



Skills

Reusable prompt-driven capabilities via
`SKILL.md`



Hooks

Event-driven automations in `hooks.json`



MCP Servers

External tool integrations via `.mcp.json`

Why Use Plugins?

Plugins solve real problems when scaling AI-assisted workflows:



Reusability Across Projects

Install once, use everywhere — no copy-pasting config files between repos



Team Standardization

Everyone on the team gets the same agents, skills, and hooks with a single install command



Share Domain Expertise

Package the knowledge of a Rails expert, a K8s specialist, or a security reviewer into a shareable plugin



Encapsulate Complexity

Wrap complex MCP server setups, multi-agent configurations, and hook chains into one installable unit

Plugins vs Manual Config

Anything a plugin does, you *could* do manually. But plugins make it better:

Feature	Manual Configuration	Plugin
Scope	Single repository	Any project ✓
Sharing	Manual copy/paste	<code>copilot plugin install</code> ✓
Versioning	Git history	Marketplace versions ✓
Discovery	Search repositories	Marketplace browsing ✓

Think of plugins as npm packages for your AI assistant — portable, versioned, discoverable.

Plugin Anatomy

```
my-plugin/  
├─ plugin.json # Required manifest  
├─ agents/ # Custom agents  
│   └─ helper.agent.md  
├─ skills/ # Reusable skills  
│   └─ deploy/  
│       └─ SKILL.md  
├─ hooks.json # Hook configuration  
└─ .mcp.json # MCP server config
```

💡 Only `plugin.json` is required. All other components are optional — include only what you need.

What Is a Marketplace?

A marketplace is a **Git repository** containing a `marketplace.json` that serves as a plugin registry.

- 1 Host on GitHub, GitLab, or any Git service
- 2 Add `marketplace.json` to `.github/plugin/`
- 3 Users register and browse via CLI

`marketplace.json` (simplified)

```
{
  "name": "my-marketplace",
  "plugins": [
    {
      "name": "frontend-design",
      "version": "2.1.0",
      "source": "../plugins/frontend-design"
    }
  ]
}
```

Default Marketplaces

Copilot CLI ships with two marketplaces pre-registered:



copilot-plugins

Official GitHub-maintained plugins — skills, hooks, and extensibility tools

```
github/copilot-plugins
```



awesome-copilot

Community-contributed agents, prompts, instructions, and skills

```
github/awesome-copilot
```

Browse & Discover

List registered marketplaces

```
$ copilot plugin marketplace list
```

Browse plugins in a marketplace

```
$ copilot plugin marketplace browse awesome-copilot
```

Or in interactive mode

```
> /plugin marketplace browse copilot-plugins
```

Install Plugins

From a registered marketplace

```
$ copilot plugin install database-data-management@awesome-copilot
```

From a GitHub repository

```
$ copilot plugin install owner/repo
```

From any Git URL

```
$ copilot plugin install https://gitlab.com/owner/repo.git
```

From a local path (development)

```
$ copilot plugin install ./my-plugin
```

💡 The repo must contain `plugin.json` in `.github/plugin/`, `.claude-plugin/`, or the repo root.

Manage Plugins

View installed plugins

```
$ copilot plugin list
```

Update a plugin

```
$ copilot plugin update plugin-name
```

Remove a plugin

```
$ copilot plugin uninstall plugin-name
```

📁 Plugins stored at `~/.copilot/state/installed-plugins/`

Create a Plugin: plugin.json

```
{
  "name": "my-dev-tools",
  "description": "React development utilities",
  "version": "1.2.0",
  "author": {
    "name": "Jane Doe",
    "email": "jane@example.com"
  },
  "license": "MIT",
  "keywords": ["react", "frontend"],
  "agents": "agents/",
  "skills": ["skills/"],
  "hooks": "hooks.json",
  "mcpServers": ".mcp.json"
}
```

name + version = identity

paths are relative to plugin root

skills accepts string or array

Dev → Test → Iterate

1

Install locally

```
copilot plugin install ./my-plugin
```

2

Verify components loaded

```
/agent      # list agents    /skills list  # list skills
```

3

Make changes → re-install (cache is used between sessions)

```
copilot plugin install ./my-plugin
```

4

Clean up when done

```
copilot plugin uninstall my-dev-tools
```

Build a Marketplace

Create `marketplace.json` in `.github/plugin/`

```
{
  "name": "my-team-marketplace",
  "owner": {
    "name": "Your Organization"
  },
  "metadata": {
    "description": "Curated plugins",
    "version": "1.0.0"
  },
  "plugins": [
    {
      "name": "security-checks",
      "version": "1.3.0",
      "source": "./plugins/security"
    }
  ]
}
```

Repository layout

```
my-marketplace/
├── .github/plugin/
│   └── marketplace.json
├── plugins/
│   ├── security/
│   │   ├── plugin.json
│   │   └── agents/
│   └── frontend/
│       ├── plugin.json
│       └── skills/
```

Share Your Marketplace

Users register your marketplace

```
$ copilot plugin marketplace add your-org/your-marketplace
```

Then install plugins from it

```
$ copilot plugin install security-checks@my-team-marketplace
```

Remove a marketplace

```
$ copilot plugin marketplace remove my-team-marketplace
```



Marketplaces work from GitHub, GitLab, any Git host, or local/shared filesystem.

Beyond GitHub: The Ecosystem

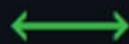
Plugin marketplaces are emerging across AI coding tools:

Feature	Copilot CLI	Claude Code	Cursor	Windsurf
Plugin format	plugin.json	plugin.json	VS Code ext	VS Code ext
Custom marketplaces	✓ Any Git repo	✓ Any Git repo	✗	✗
CLI install	✓	✓	GUI only	GUI only
Cross-compatible	✓	✓	✗	✗

Cross-Compatibility



Copilot CLI



Claude Code

`.github/plugin/` — recognized by both Copilot CLI and Claude Code

`.claude-plugin/` — also recognized by both tools

One plugin → two ecosystems. Write once, use everywhere.

Claude Code Marketplace

Anthropic maintains **36+ official plugins** at `anthropics/claude-code`:

- `code-review` — Confidence-scored code review
- `frontend-design` — Professional GUI generation
- `feature-dev` — Full dev workflow
- `plugin-dev` — Plugin development tools
- `commit-commands` — Git workflow automation

Register it in Copilot CLI:

```
$ copilot plugin marketplace add \anthropics/claude-code
```

Then install its plugins:

```
$ copilot plugin install \code-review@claude-code
```

Quick Reference

Discover & Install

```
copilot plugin marketplace list
copilot plugin marketplace browse NAME
copilot plugin install PLUGIN@MKT
copilot plugin install owner/repo
```

Manage

```
copilot plugin list
copilot plugin update NAME
copilot plugin uninstall NAME
```

Marketplaces

```
copilot plugin marketplace add owner/repo
copilot plugin marketplace remove NAME
```

Develop

```
copilot plugin install ./my-plugin
/agent /skills list
```



Start Extending

Browse → Install → Create → Share

[copilot-plugins →](#)

[awesome-copilot →](#)

GitHub Copilot Marketplaces — Extend, Create, Share